

Day 3 — Research Begins

Module: Project Implementation · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will have identified at least one verifiable source from their anchor module and one verifiable secondary source, recorded each in their journal with the exact citation, and made initial notes on what each source contributes to their project.

Materials

- Each anchor module's printed `sources.md` (teacher prepares a small shelf of these)
- Notebook / project journal
- Sticky tabs (for marking pages students will come back to)
- Sample citation slips (see template below)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily prompt: “*What’s one thing you’re worried about with your project?*” — 3 students share. Normalise the worry.
- “Research is just finding the people who’ve already thought about your question. You’re not the first.”

Core (10 min)

1. **What counts as a source** (3 min). Three categories:
 - **Primary scriptural / textual source** — a named verse, *sūtra*, or chapter from a real published text (e.g. Bhāgavatam 3.26.36; *Caraka Saṁhitā* Sūtrasthāna 1.41; Tirthaji *Vedic Mathematics* p. 56). Found in any prior module's `.rag-cache/` or `sources.md`.
 - **Secondary reference** — an NCERT textbook chapter, a published field guide, or a peer-reviewed article. Found in your anchor module's `sources.md`.
 - **Primary observation** — something you saw, measured, or photographed yourself, with date and location.

At least one source from category 1 or 2. Primary observations count toward your minimum two but cannot be the only source.

2. **What does NOT count** (2 min):
 - “Some say...” without naming who.
 - A WhatsApp forward.
 - An AI-generated paraphrase you can't trace.
 - A YouTube video without references in its description.

3. **Citation format** (3 min). For each source, your journal slip needs:
 - **Source identifier** (e.g. “SB 3.26.36” or “NCERT Class 7 Science Ch. 2”)
 - **Where you found it** (e.g. “module-04-doshas/.rag-cache/day-02-dosha-basics.json”)
 - **What it says, in your words** (1-2 sentences)
 - **How it relates to your project** (1 sentence)
4. **Two-source minimum, three is comfortable** (2 min). Hit at least one of category 1 or 2, plus one more. Three sources is the sweet spot for a Middle-band project — more becomes hard to manage.

Activity (25 min) — Source hunt

Refer to `activities/activity-01-source-hunt.md` for the full activity. Quick summary:

- Students sit in clusters by anchor module (all Module 10 students together, all Module 4 together, etc.). This lets them help each other find the right cache file.
- Each student opens their anchor module’s `sources.md` and `.rag-cache/`. They scan for relevant entries.
- For each candidate source they want to use, they fill in a **citation slip** (template below).
- Minimum: 2 completed slips by end of class.

Citation slip template

CITATION SLIP – Source #__

Source identifier: _____

Where I found it: _____

What it says (1–2 sentences in my own words):

How this relates to my project (1 sentence):

This is a [primary text / secondary reference / primary observation] source.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- **Submit citation slips** at the in-tray. Teacher reviews tonight.
- Journal entry: “Today I found ____ . The biggest surprise was ____ .”
- Preview Day 4: “*Tomorrow we keep researching and you make your first design sketch. Bring whatever drawing tools you’ll need.*”

Student-facing content

Today you find your sources.

Three categories count: 1. A named verse, sūtra, or chapter from a real published text. 2. An NCERT chapter, field guide, or peer-reviewed article. 3. A primary observation you made yourself, with date and location.

You need at least two sources total, at least one from category 1 or 2.

What does NOT count: - “Some say...” without naming who. - A WhatsApp forward. - An AI paraphrase you can’t trace.

Fill in two citation slips by end of class.

Homework

- Open the cache files on a computer at home if available. Read the full chunks (not just the summary).
- If a source you want isn’t in the cache, search for the chapter in a school library or ask a parent.
- Bring drawing tools tomorrow.

Differentiation

- **One tier up:** Find a third source from a *different* category than your first two. For instance, if you have two cache verses, find one NCERT chapter or one primary observation to triangulate.
- **One tier down:** Stop at two solid sources rather than chasing more. Spend the saved time writing what each source contributes in 3 sentences — clarity beats volume.

Teacher notes

- Some students will find no relevant sources in their anchor module’s cache. Walk over and help — sometimes the relevant verse is in a *different* module (e.g. a Doṣa project may pull from Module 3 Ayurveda rather than Module 4).
- The Project 9 (multiplication comparison) anchor sources are slightly different — they include Tirthaji’s book and the day-by-day worked examples from Modules 7, 9, 11. Help these students locate the right pages.
- Project 7 (sustainability audit) students often want to leap straight to primary observation. Hold them: they need at least one *prior* source to anchor their framework first. Module 13’s sources .md (when available) is the place.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- The lesson references the citation discipline established from Module 2 onwards. No new scripture citation today.